

JOB SEARCH & PERSONAL BRANDING TOOLKIT

Sathvik Sriram

Target Role: Business Program Manager — Microsoft CoreAI Division, India Development Center

Section 1 — ATS-Friendly Cover Letter

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Business Program Manager role within Microsoft's CoreAI Division at the India Development Center. Having spent the last five years operating as a Chief-of-Staff-style leader inside a fast-scaling Gen AI organization, I understand what it takes to run Rhythm of Business at scale, hold budget and fiscal discipline, and translate leadership priorities into outcomes that cross-functional teams can execute against.

In my current role as Senior Manager at EXL Service, I built and executed a 12-month Generative AI roadmap for the Healthcare business unit, evaluating 6 proof-of-concepts and advancing 4 to MVP in direct partnership with leadership. I led cross-functional collaboration across two agile teams and a six-member architecture guild — 13+ people in total — setting vision, prioritizing roadmaps, and standardizing delivery patterns across four product lines. This work generated approximately \$17M in revenue across four client engagements through executive-level stakeholder alignment with development, security, compliance, and SME teams, and it required the same operating cadence CoreAI's Business Program Manager role demands: structured RoB, clear ownership, and consistent executive communication.

Fiscal discipline has been a consistent thread in my work. I drove a 28% reduction (~\$64K) in annual R&D cloud costs within three months through financial review and compute optimization, and earlier in my career I improved Days Sales Outstanding by 9 days (94 to 85) by redesigning invoice review and reconciliation processes. Both initiatives required the operational rigor and budget ownership this role calls for — diagnosing inefficiency, building the business case, and driving it to closure.

I also bring direct experience preparing leadership communications: I authored and published 12+ monthly executive briefings and industry research newsletters for VP+ stakeholders, and led end-to-end planning for six Healthcare conferences, owning executive content design and VP+ networking. These experiences mirror the leadership-enablement and executive-briefing responsibilities at the center of this role.

What I believe differentiates my candidacy is the combination of operational/fiscal rigor with genuine technical fluency in AI — I've designed Python-based agent evaluation frameworks, rolled out AI coding assistants org-wide (improving sprint velocity by 35%), and led teams building Gen AI products end-to-end. For a Business Program Manager role inside CoreAI specifically, that combination means I can engage credibly with both the business operating rhythm and the product/technical context driving it.

I hold an MBA from IIM Calcutta (CAT 99.69 percentile) and am PMP, CSPO, and AWS Cloud Practitioner certified. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in cross-org strategy, fiscal governance, and executive enablement can support the Site Leader and Leadership Team at CoreAI India.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Sathvik Sriram
sathvik.sriram@gmail.com | +91 7022209405 | linkedin.com/in/sathvik-sriram

(Word count: ~410)

Section 2 — Recruiter Outreach Email

Subject: Senior Manager (EXL) → Business Program Manager, CoreAI — IIM-C MBA, \$17M+ revenue impact
Hi [Recruiter Name],

I'm reaching out regarding the Business Program Manager opening on the CoreAI team at Microsoft IDC. I currently operate in a Chief-of-Staff-style capacity as Senior Manager at EXL Service, where I run Rhythm of Business for a Gen AI organization, own budget and fiscal planning, and lead cross-functional teams of 13+ across agile and architecture functions.

A few data points that map directly to this role:

- Built and executed a 12-month Gen AI roadmap for a Healthcare business unit; advanced 4 of 6 evaluated POCs to MVP
- Generated ~\$17M in revenue across 4 client projects through executive-level stakeholder alignment
- Reduced R&D cloud costs by 28% (~\$64K) within 3 months through fiscal review and process redesign
- Authored 12+ monthly executive briefings for VP+ leadership and led planning for 6 industry conferences

I hold an MBA from IIM Calcutta (CAT 99.69 percentile) and am PMP, CSPO, and AWS Cloud Practitioner certified. I'd welcome a short call to discuss fit and answer any questions about my background.

My resume is attached. Happy to work around your schedule this week.

Best regards,
Sathvik Sriram
+91 7022209405 | sathvik.sriram@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/sathvik-sriram

Section 3 — Hiring Manager Email

Subject: Business Program Manager, CoreAI — Operating rhythm + fiscal governance experience
Hi [Hiring Manager Name],

I came across the Business Program Manager opening on your team at CoreAI and wanted to reach out directly, as the role's emphasis on Rhythm of Business, fiscal discipline, and leadership enablement closely mirrors what I do today.

As Senior Manager at EXL Service, I operate in a Chief-of-Staff-style capacity for a Gen AI organization — owning the 12-month product roadmap, leading 13+ people across agile and architecture functions, and standardizing delivery patterns across four product lines. On the fiscal side, I drove a 28% (~\$64K) reduction in annual R&D cloud costs within three months, and earlier in my career improved DSO by 9 days through process redesign — both required the same financial discipline and operational rigor this role calls for.

I also have direct experience in the leadership-enablement side of the role: authoring 12+ monthly executive briefings for VP+ stakeholders and leading end-to-end planning for 6 Healthcare industry conferences, including executive content design and senior-leader networking.

I'd value the chance to learn more about how you're scaling the BPM function within CoreAI and to share more about how my background in cross-org strategy and fiscal governance could contribute. Would you be open to a brief conversation in the coming weeks?

I've attached my resume for context. Thank you for your time.

Best,

Sathvik Sriram

+91 7022209405 | sathvik.sriram@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/sathvik-sriram](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sathvik-sriram)

Section 4 — LinkedIn Connection Request (Max 300 characters)

Hi [Name], I'm a Senior Manager at EXL running a Chief-of-Staff-style function — RoB, fiscal planning, exec briefings — for a Gen AI org. Saw the CoreAI Business Program Manager opening and would love to connect and learn more about the team. — Sathvik

(279 characters)

Section 5 — Referral Request Message

Hi [Contact Name],

Hope you're doing well! I noticed Microsoft's CoreAI team has an opening for a Business Program Manager at the IDC, and I think it's a strong match for my background — I currently run a Chief-of-Staff-style function at EXL Service, owning Rhythm of Business, budget/fiscal planning, and executive briefings for a Gen AI organization of 13+ people.

A few highlights: I've generated ~\$17M in revenue across 4 client projects through executive stakeholder alignment, cut R&D cloud costs by 28% (~\$64K) in 3 months, and authored 12+ monthly executive briefings for VP+ leadership. I also hold an MBA from IIM Calcutta and am PMP/CSPO certified.

If you're open to it, would you be willing to refer me for this role, or connect me with someone on the hiring team? I'd be happy to send over my resume and a short blurb to make it easy. No worries at all if the timing isn't right — really appreciate you considering it either way.

Thanks so much,
Sathvik

Section 6 — Follow-Up Email (Send after 5 days if no response)

Subject: Re: Business Program Manager, CoreAI — following up

Hi [Name],

Wanted to follow up on my note from last week regarding the Business Program Manager role on the CoreAI team. I know things get busy, so no pressure at all — just wanted to make sure it didn't slip through.

To briefly recap: I run a Chief-of-Staff-style function at EXL Service, leading Rhythm of Business, fiscal planning, and executive enablement for a 13+ person Gen AI organization, with a track record that includes ~\$17M in revenue generated across 4 client projects and a 28% reduction in R&D cloud costs.

I remain very interested in the opportunity and would welcome the chance to speak whenever convenient on your end. Happy to share any additional information that would help.

Thanks again for your time and consideration.

Best,

Sathvik Sriram

+91 7022209405 | sathvik.sriram@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/sathvik-sriram

Section 7 — 30-Second Professional Introduction

“I'm Sathvik Sriram — I operate as a Chief-of-Staff-style Senior Manager at EXL Service, where I run Rhythm of Business for a Generative AI organization. That means I own the budget and fiscal planning, lead cross-functional teams of 13-plus across agile and architecture functions, and write the executive briefings that VP-level leaders use to make decisions. Over the past year I built a 12-month Gen AI roadmap, generated about \$17 million in revenue across four client projects, and cut our R&D cloud spend by 28% — roughly \$64,000 — in three months. I've got an MBA from IIM Calcutta and I'm PMP and CSPO certified. What I bring that's a little different is real technical fluency alongside the operating rigor — I build agent evaluation frameworks and roll out AI tooling myself, so I can sit credibly in rooms with both business and engineering leaders. Right now I'm exploring Business Program Manager and Chief-of-Staff roles where that combination — operational discipline plus AI fluency — adds the most value.”

(~165 words, ~30–35 seconds at natural pace)

Section 8 — Top 10 Job Titles Best Suited for This Profile

1. Business Program Manager
2. Chief of Staff
3. Senior Program Manager (Business Operations)
4. Business Operations Manager
5. Director / Head of Business Operations
6. Strategy & Operations Manager
7. Executive Business Administrator (Sr.)
8. Corporate Strategy Manager
9. AI Program Manager (Business/Operations track)
10. GM Office / Leadership Office Program Manager

Section 9 — Key Strengths Recruiters Will Notice

- Quantified revenue and cost impact: ~\$17M generated across 4 client projects; 28% (~\$64K) R&D cloud cost reduction; 9-day DSO improvement — a candidate who ties operational work to hard numbers, not just activity.
- True Chief-of-Staff operating experience: Rhythm of Business ownership, budget/headcount/fiscal planning, and executive briefings for VP+ stakeholders — not adjacent PM work, but the actual function this role is hiring for.
- Scale of cross-functional leadership: 13+ people across 2 agile teams and an architecture guild, standardizing delivery across 4 product lines — evidence of influence without direct authority.
- AI/Gen AI fluency that's hands-on, not just strategic: built Python-based agent evaluation frameworks, ran 100+ synthetic test scenarios, rolled out AI coding assistants org-wide (35% sprint velocity gain) — a rare combination for a business-ops profile and a direct fit for CoreAI specifically.
- Top-tier pedigree: MBA from IIM Calcutta at the 99.69th percentile, with PMP, CSPO, and AWS Cloud Practitioner certifications layered on top.
- Executive communication track record: 12+ monthly executive briefings, 6 industry conferences led end-to-end — direct, repeated proof of the leadership-enablement function.

Section 10 — Skill Gap Analysis

Current Strengths

- Rhythm of Business design and execution at organizational scale
- Budget, fiscal, and headcount planning with demonstrated cost-reduction outcomes
- Executive briefing authorship and VP+ stakeholder communication
- Cross-functional leadership (agile + architecture functions, 13+ people)
- Hands-on AI/ML exposure: Python, LLM agents, prompt engineering, evals, fine-tuning
- Cloud platform familiarity: Azure, GCP, AWS, Databricks
- Process redesign with measurable financial outcomes (DSO, cloud cost)
- Strong academic credentials (IIM-C MBA) and PM certifications (PMP, CSPO)

Missing or Light Skills (relative to this specific JD)

- No explicit experience with employee listening tools or organizational health metrics (e.g., Thriving/Signals-style engagement scoring) — called out specifically under Organizational Health in the JD
- No stated experience with GTM motions, MCAPS-style field collaboration, or Customer Advisory Board representation — relevant to the Product Strategy section of the JD
- No explicit mention of campus recruiting or apprentice/Springboard-style hiring program experience — called out under Business Operations in the JD
- Limited visibility into multi-site/multi-geo operations (the JD asks for architecting workflows across Hyderabad, Bengaluru, and Noida specifically)
- No formal change-management or org-design certification (e.g., Prosci) despite doing change-adjacent work

Recommended Learning Roadmap (4–6 weeks)

Week 1–2: Organizational Health & Employee Engagement

- Study common employee listening/engagement platforms (Glint, Qualtrics, Microsoft Viva) and how engagement scoring frameworks work
- Review Microsoft's public materials on Viva Insights / Viva Glint to speak credibly to “Thriving/Signals” language used in the JD

Week 3: GTM & Field Collaboration Literacy

- Build basic fluency in how enterprise GTM motions work with field/partner teams (public Microsoft careers content on MCAPS structure)
- Prepare 1–2 stories reframing your existing stakeholder-alignment work (e.g., the \$17M revenue generation) in GTM-adjacent language

Week 4: Multi-Site Operations Framing

- Reframe existing experience (remote-first delivery across distributed teams) explicitly as multi-geo operational coordination
- Prepare a specific narrative on how you'd approach architecting workflows across 3 cities if asked in interview

Week 5–6: Optional Certification Layer

- Consider a short, low-cost change-management primer (e.g., Prosci ADKAR overview) to round out the org-transformation angle

This roadmap is interview-prep focused rather than resume-rebuilding — your core qualifications already meet the JD's required and most preferred criteria; the gaps above are about being fully prepared to speak fluently to every JD section, not about being underqualified.

Section 11 — Personal Brand Summary

Unique Value Proposition

A Chief-of-Staff-style operator who pairs enterprise-grade fiscal and operational discipline with genuine, hands-on AI/ML fluency — able to own Rhythm of Business and budget governance for a Gen AI organization while also building the evaluation frameworks and tooling that organization runs on.

Professional Positioning Statement

Sathvik Sriram is a Business Program Manager and Chief-of-Staff-style leader with 5+ years driving cross-org strategy, fiscal governance, and executive enablement inside fast-scaling Generative AI organizations. He combines IIM Calcutta MBA-level strategic rigor with direct technical fluency in AI — a combination that lets him operate credibly across business, engineering, and executive stakeholders simultaneously, backed by a track record of \$17M+ in revenue generated, 28% cloud cost reduction, and consistent executive-briefing delivery to VP+ leadership.

Recruiter Headline

Chief-of-Staff-Style Business Program Manager | Gen AI Org Operations | \$17M+ Revenue Impact | 28% Cost Reduction | IIM Calcutta MBA | PMP/CSPO

Section 12 — Interview Talking Points

Most Impressive Achievements (lead with these)

1. \$17M revenue across 4 client projects — driven through executive-level stakeholder alignment across development, security, compliance, and SME teams. Strongest “business impact” story.
2. 28% (~\$64K) R&D cloud cost reduction in 3 months — a clean fiscal-discipline story with a fast timeline, signaling urgency and execution speed.
3. 12-month Gen AI roadmap, 6 POCs evaluated, 4 advanced to MVP — best “strategic ownership + technical credibility” story, especially relevant for a CoreAI-specific interview.
4. DSO improvement, 94→85 days — smaller in scale but a great process-redesign example applied to a different financial lever, showing range.
5. 35% sprint velocity improvement via AI tooling rollout (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code) — directly relevant to CoreAI's mission of empowering developers to build with AI; mirrors the company's own mission language naturally.

Key Stories to Have Ready (STAR-formatted)

- The \$64K cloud cost story: Situation (rising R&D cloud spend), Task (asked to find savings), Action (financial review + compute optimization + process redesign), Result (28% reduction in 3 months). Good for “tell me about a time you drove fiscal discipline.”
- The 12+ executive briefings story: shows sustained, repeated execution (not a one-off) — good for “how do you communicate with senior leadership.”
- The 6 Healthcare conferences story: good for “tell me about representing the organization externally” — maps directly to the JD's Customer Advisory Board / Executive Briefing Center language.
- The agent evaluation framework story: Python-based evals across accuracy, completeness, policy adherence, reasoning, run across 100+ synthetic scenarios — good for any question probing genuine technical depth vs. surface-level AI familiarity.

Areas Recruiters/Interviewers Are Likely to Ask About

- How you'd approach Rhythm of Business across three different cities (Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Noida) — prepare a specific point of view, since this is explicitly called out in the JD.
- How you handle organizational health / employee engagement metrics — be ready to speak conceptually even without Microsoft-specific tool experience (see Section 10).
- Why the move from a services/consulting environment (EXL) to a product organization (Microsoft CoreAI) — have a clear, confident narrative; frame it as wanting to apply your operating rigor closer to the product itself.
- Scope and scale comparison — your current org is 13+ people; this role supports 600+. Be ready to speak to how your frameworks scale rather than being specific to a smaller team.
- Your CAT 99.69 percentile and IIM-C MBA will likely come up as a credibility marker — have a brief, non-arrogant way of mentioning it that ties back to strategic thinking rather than just credentialing.